PP-R-21E
May 26, 1976
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec.
PP-R-0021D(Army-GL)
September 30, 1970 and
Fed. Spec. PP-R-21C
November 6, 1964

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

RABBITS, CHILLED OR FROZEN, READY-TO-COOK

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service General Services Administration for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers chilled or frozen ready-to-cook (eviscerated) domestic rabbits.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types, classes, styles, grades, and weight ranges. The rabbits shall be of the following types, classes, styles, grades, and weight ranges, as specified (see 6.1).

1.2.1.1 Types.

Type I	-	Fresh chilled (see 3.2.1)
Type II	-	Frozen not more than 60 days (see 3.2.2)
Type III	-	Frozen more than 60 days (see 3.2.3)
Type IV	-	Frozen (special) (see 3.2.4)

1.2.1.2 Classes.

Class 1	-	Fryer or young rabbit
Class 2	-	Roaster or mature rabbit

FSC 8905

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1.2.1.3 Styles.

Style 1 - Ready-to-cook, whole
Style 2 - Ready-to-cook, cut-up

1.2.1.4 Grades.

Grade A
Grade B
Grade C

1.2.1.5 Weight ranges. Ready-to-cook rabbits shall conform to the following weight range or as specified (see 6.1):

	Weight range per carcass	
	Minimum	Maximum
Class 1 fryer	1 lb, 8 oz (0.68 kg)	3 lb, 8 oz (1.59 kg)
Class 2 roaster	3 lb, 8 oz (1.59 kg)	7 lb (3.17 kg)

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

L-C-110 - Cellophane (Coated and Noncoated Regenerated Cellulose Film)
L-P-378 - Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-101 - Preservation, Packaging and Packing Materials; Test Procedures
FED-STD-123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies)

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(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers, at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS:

US Department of Agriculture

Regulations Governing the Grading and Inspection of Domestic Rabbits and Edible Products Thereof and United States Specifications for Classes, Standards, and Grades with Respect Thereto (7 CFR Part 54).

United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Information Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, US Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

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US Department of Health, Education, and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. All products shall be processed and chilled or frozen under continuous Government inspection in accordance with US Department of Agriculture Regulations Governing the Grading and Inspection of Domestic Rabbits and Edible Products Thereof and United States Specifications for Classes, Standards, and Grades with Respect Thereto.

3.2 Types. All types of product shall be in excellent condition at time of delivery. Types II, III, and IV, after being frozen and until time for delivery, shall be held at a temperature not higher than 0°F (-18°C). The contractor shall provide evidence that the internal temperature of the product at time of shipment does not exceed 0°F (-18°C). The internal temperature of the product at destination shall not exceed 0°F (-18°C).

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3.2.1 Type I, fresh chilled. Rabbits shall be processed subsequent to date of award of contract. Immediately after evisceration and washing, carcasses shall be placed in a cooling tank containing running, cold tap water to remove the animal heat. Carcasses shall not be allowed to remain in the cooling tank for longer than 1 hour. Immediately after cooling, the carcasses shall be placed in open cooling racks and thereupon placed under refrigeration with moderate air movements and at a temperature which will reduce the internal temperature of the carcasses to 40°F (4°C) or less within 24 hours. The carcasses shall be held at temperatures of 36°F (2°C) or below without the tissues containing ice crystals and shall be delivered in a well chilled and prime condition.

3.2.2 Type II, frozen not more than 60 days. Rabbits shall be solidly frozen in accordance with US Department of Agriculture Regulations Governing the Grading and Inspection of Domestic Rabbits and Edible Products Thereof and United States Specifications for Classes, Standards, and Grades with Respect Thereto. Freezer storage time shall be limited to 60 days. Storage time shall include the date put into the freezer and shall be computed from the time of initial inspection.

3.2.3 Type III, frozen more than 60 days. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), rabbits shall comply with 3.2.2 except that freezer storage time shall be limited to 120 days when the product is being procured for export purposes and 180 days when it is being procured for domestic purposes.

3.2.4 Type IV, frozen (special). The packed carcasses which have been chilled according to 3.2.1 shall be placed in the freezer within 6 hours from the time of packing. The freezing operation shall be accomplished in a manner which will result in freezing the carcasses solid in less than 48 hours. After being frozen and until the time of delivery, the product shall be held in a freezer at a temperature not higher than 0°F (-18°C). The internal temperature of the product at destination shall not exceed 0°F (-18°C).

3.3 Classes.

3.3.1 Class 1. Fryer or young rabbit shall be a young domestic rabbit carcass weighing within the applicable weight range specified in 1.2.1.5. The flesh of a fryer or young rabbit shall be tender and fine grained and of a bright pearly pink color.

3.3.2 Class 2. Roaster or mature rabbit shall be a mature domestic rabbit carcass weighing within the applicable weight range specified in 1.2.1.5. The flesh of a roaster or mature rabbit is more firm and coarse grained, and the muscle fiber is slightly darker in color and less tender and the fat may be more creamy in color than that of a fryer or young rabbit.

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3.4 Styles.

3.4.1 Style 1. Ready-to-cook, whole carcasses shall be domestic rabbits from which the head, blood, skin, feet, and inedible viscera have been removed. Kidneys need not be removed unless otherwise specified. The liver shall be properly cleaned and included with the carcass. The heart, properly cleaned, may also be included with the carcass.

3.4.2 Style 2. Ready-to-cook, cut-up carcasses shall conform to 3.4.1 and shall be further processed in accordance with 3.6.

3.5 Grades. The interpretation of requirements shall be in accordance with standards of quality set forth in Regulations Governing the Grading and Inspection of Domestic Rabbits and Edible Products Thereof and United States Specifications for Classes, Standards, and Grades with Respect Thereto.

3.6 Processing (style 2, ready-to-cook, cut-up). Style 2, cut-up carcasses shall be cut with a band saw as follows:

Step 1: The foreleg and breast is removed from the remainder of the carcass by cutting straight across the backbone at the eighth or ninth thoracic vertebrae. This part is further divided by splitting down the backbone so as to form two equal halves.

Step 2: The rib is separated from the remainder of the carcass by cutting straight across the backbone between the third and fourth lumbar vertebrae. The rib section is further divided by splitting down the backbone.

Step 3: The loin is separated from the rump by cutting straight across the backbone between the sixth and seventh lumbar vertebrae. There is no further division of this part.

Step 4: The rump is separated from the hind legs by cutting on a straight line from the base of the tail to a point approximately 1/2 inch (13 mm) above the stifle joint. There is no further division of the rump.

Step 5: The hind legs, after being separated from the rump as described in step 4 need no further division.

3.7 Plant qualification. The product shall originate, be processed, marked and handled in plants which are operated under the Regulations Governing the Grading and Inspection of Domestic Rabbits and Edible Products Thereof and United States Specifications for Classes, Standards, and Grades with Respect Thereto or by other government agencies officially recognized by the US Department of Agriculture.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Plant qualification conditions. The product furnished under this document shall be unacceptable if not produced and stored in plants which currently meet the qualification conditions of 3.7 (see also 6.6).

4.3 Acceptance inspection.

4.3.1 Condition inspection of containers. When inspection of containers for condition is performed by the US Department of Agriculture, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers shall apply.

4.3.2 Sampling for inspection (military agencies). Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3.3 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.3.1 Testing of components. Testing of components described in this specification shall be in accordance with table I. Results shall apply to the lot average.

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TABLE I. Testing of components (level B)

Components	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Inspection level	Characteristics	Results reported	Test ref & rqmts par
Unwaxed paper, waxed paper or vegetable parchment (as applicable)	Three sq yards (2.5 sq m) of cut sheets	Number of reams	S-1	Basis weight	Nearest pound (kg)	5.1.1.3.1, 5.1.1.3.2
				Weight of wax per ream	Nearest pound (kg)	5.1.1.3.1
				Melting point of wax	Nearest 1°F (1°C)	5.1.1.3.1
				Bursting strength	Nearest point	5.1.1.3.1, 5.1.1.3.2
				Tearing resistance	Nearest gram	5.1.1.3.1, 5.1.1.3.2
Plastic film wrapper, except polyethylene	One bag or sheet	Number of bags or sheets	S-1	Thickness	Nearest 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm)	5.1.1.3.3
Cellophane	1/2 yard (0.4 sq m) full width	Rolls	S-1	Thickness	Nearest gauge	5.1.1.3.4
Fiberboard box	One box	Number of boxes	S-1	Wax melting point	Nearest 1°F (1°C)	5.2(a)
				Polyethylene coating thickness	Nearest 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm)	5.2(b)
Liner	Liner	Liners	S-1	Basis weight	Pound per ream (gm per sq meter)	5.2(c) 5.2(d)

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4.3.3.2 In-process examination. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1) examination shall be performed during processing to determine compliance with the inspection and grading requirements of 3.1 and the condition, dressing, washing, cooling and applicable cutting and freezing requirements of 3.2 and 3.4. With reference to inspection and grading, examination shall be performed in accordance with the USDA regulations and specifications referenced in 3.1, except as follows: When the establishment utilizes USDA wholesomeness inspection, compliance with the inspection and grade requirements shall be determined as having been satisfied when examination reveals that each shipping container bears the official USDA grade legend for the grade specified. Failure to comply with one or more of the above requirements shall be basis for rejection of the finished product.

4.3.4 Examination of end item. Classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with table III and 4.3.5 and 4.3.6. The inspection levels, sample units, expression of lot sizes and the acceptable quality levels (AQLs) shall be as shown in table II. AQLs shall be expressed in defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. End item examination criteria

Table	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Inspection level	AQLs	
				Major B	Minor
III	Bag, wrapper or carton	Shipping container	S-3	2.5	10.0

4.3.5 Examination of net weight. The sample unit for examination of net weight shall be one filled package or container. Lot size shall be expressed in packages or containers, as applicable. The sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level 1. The lot shall be rejected if, by using recognized statistical methods, the sample average net weight is determined to be less than the specified average net weight.

4.3.6 Examination of shipping container (level B and C). Examination of shipping container for level B pack shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be included in the table of examination: Major (1) Marking missing, incorrect or illegible. (2) Not lined or waxed as specified. Minor (1) Insufficient wax (see 5.2(a)). For level C pack, examination shall be in accordance with the foregoing specification except only the additional defects shall apply.

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TABLE III. Examination of packaging and contents

Category		Defect
Major B	Minor	
		Cartons:
151		Carton not folding or set-up type made of material specified (see 5.1.1.2) (level B).
152		Carton not completely lined or waxed and overwrapped as specified (see 5.1.1.2) (level B).
	201	Less than one cut-up rabbit, more than 15 pounds (6.8 kg) of rabbit parts, or rabbit parts not present in proportion in which they exist in the carcass (all levels).
		Contents:
153		Product not in specified weight range (all levels) (see 1.2.1.5) (all levels).
	202	Liver(s) missing or does not correspond to number of rabbits (all levels). If heart is included the number of hearts exceed the number of rabbits (all levels).
		Wrapper or bag as applicable:
154		Not specified material (see 5.1.1.1) (level B).
	203	Torn or missing (level B).
	204	Not individually, tightly and completely wrapped around rabbit (level B).

4.4 Examination and test methods. Examination and test procedures which differ from those specified herein, unless otherwise excepted, may be used by the supplier if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government inspection activity determines that such procedures and control do not provide as a minimum such quality assurance, the supplier will use the procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to examination or test results, the procedures specified herein will govern.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Types II, III, and IV product, all classes and styles, shall be packaged in accordance with level B or C, as specified (see 6.1). Type I product, all classes and styles, shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.2 or as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level B (types II, III, and IV, all classes). Packaging shall be as specified hereinafter for the applicable style product.

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5.1.1.1 Style 1. Each rabbit shall be individually, tightly, and completely wrapped in a sheet or inserted into a bag made from one of the wrapping materials specified in 5.1.1.3. The sheet, if used, shall be of sufficient size to cover the flesh of the rabbit completely to prevent the loss of moisture, and when closed as required herein will result in the formation of a bag.

5.1.1.2 Style 2. Not less than one cut-up rabbit nor more than 15 pounds (6.8 kg) of rabbit parts in the proportion in which they exist in the carcass shall be packaged in a folding or set-up carton made of solid bleached sulphite, solid manila box-board, or of board having inner and outer surfaces of these materials. All of the inside surfaces shall be completely lined (may be laminated) with one of the materials specified in 5.1.1.3. When specified, one style 2 cut-up rabbit shall be packaged in an individual carton (see 6.1). Cartons need not be lined if the interior surface is waxed and cartons overwrapped in one of the materials specified in 5.1.1.3.

5.1.1.3 Wrapping materials. The wrappers shall be made of the following materials. The wrapper or bag shall be heat-sealed, string tied, secured with pressure-sensitive tape, or closed with a twist of wire, rubber band or plastic or metal clip. The wrapper may be prefabricated into a bag or pouch.

5.1.1.3.1 Waxed paper. The waxed paper shall be bleached, semibleached or unbleached deodorized kraft or sulphite having a minimum basis weight before waxing of 40 pounds per ream (65 grams per sq meter) (24 by 36-500) when tested in accordance with method 5022 of FED-STD-101, The paper shall be completely wet waxed on both sides with a total of not less than 11 pounds per ream (18 g per sq meter) of a fully refined paraffin wax having melting point of not less than 125°F (52°C), as determined by method 4017 of FED-STD-101. The sheets shall have a bursting strength of not less than 22 points when tested in accordance with method 2007 of FED-STD-101 and a tearing resistance of not less than 18 grams when tested in accordance with method 2036 of FED-STD-101.

5.1.1.3.2 Vegetable parchment. The vegetable parchment paper shall have a minimum basis weight of 26 pounds per ream (42 gm per sq meter) (24 by 36-500) when tested in accordance with method 5022 of FED-STD-101. The sheet shall have an average bursting strength of not less than 22 points when tested in accordance with method 2007 of FED-STD-101 and an average tearing resistance in any direction of not less than 18 grams when tested in accordance with method 2036 of FED-STD-101.

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5.1.1.3.3 Plastic film wrappers (sheet or bag). The wrapper shall be one of the following:

(a) A copolymer of vinylidene chloride vinyl chloride not less than 0.0006 inch (0.015 mm) thick.
(b) Polyvinyl chloride with suitable food grade plasticizers not less than 0.002 inch (0.05 mm) thick.
(c) Polyethylene not less than 0.0015 inch (0.038 mm) thick or heat shrinkable polyethylene not less than 0.001 inch (0.025 mm) thick. Polyethylene shall be tested in accordance with L-P-378.
(d) A polyethylene terepthalate film not less than 0.005 inch (0.127 mm) thick.
(e) A special frozen food rubber hydrochloride-base plastic film not less than 0.0005 inch (0.0127 mm) thick.

5.1.1.3.4 Cellophane. Cellophane shall be 195 gauge in accordance with type V, class 2, or type VI, of L-C-110.

5.1.2 Level C. Rabbits shall be packaged in a manner to assure protection against damage and deterioration during shipment from the supply source to the first consuming activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets these requirements. When specified (see 6.1), one style 2 cut-up rabbit shall be packaged in an individual carton.

5.2 Packing. Not more than 50 pounds (22.5 kg) of types II, III, and IV rabbit, all classes and styles, shall be packed in a snug fitting shipping container in accordance with level B or C, as specified (see 6.1). Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), type I rabbit, all classes and styles, shall be packed with ice in a suitable commercial container. Unless the rabbit is packaged in a carton or packaged and sealed in one of the materials specified in 5.1.1.3.3, the interior surfaces of the body and cover of the shipping container shall be protected from juices by one of the following methods:

(a) Hot waxing the interior surfaces with a fully refined paraffin wax having a melting point of not less than 52°C (125°F) as determined by method 4017 of FED-STD-101. The quantity of wax shall be sufficient to show presence of wax on the fingernail when it has been scraped across the board.
(b) Coating with not less than 0.0127 mm (0.0005 inch) thick polyethylene.
(c) Completely lined with two sheets of waxed paper as specified in 5.1.1.3.1. One sheet shall be cut and placed to cover the bottom, ends and top with an overlap of 4 inches (102 mm) on top and extending 1 inch (25 mm) along the side panel at each corner. The other sheet shall be cut and placed to cover the bottom sides and top with an overlap of 4 inches (102 mm) on top and extending 1 inch (25 mm) along the end panels at each corner.
(d) Lining with a prefabricated box liner made from one of the materials specified in 5.1.1.3.1 through 5.1.1.3.4.

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5.2.1 Level B. The shipping container shall be a fiberboard box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style FTC, V3c, V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.1 When specified (see 6.1 and 6.3), the shipping container specified in 5.2.1 shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.2 When specified (see 6.1 and 6.4) the shipping container shall be a fiberboard box, constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with style FTC, W5c or W5s of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level C. Rabbits, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies.

5.3.1.1 Wrappers, bags and cartons. Any commercial labeling, or additional labeling as specified that complies with the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder is acceptable. The net weight of the cartons shall be marked on the cartons.

5.3.1.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of FED-STD-123, and such other information as specified by individual agencies.

5.3.2 Military agencies.

5.3.2.1 Individual cartons. Commercial labeling will be acceptable provided the following information appears on the carton:

CLASS AND STYLES OF CONTENTS
NET WEIGHT

5.3.2.1.1 Wrappers. Labeling of wrappers is not required.

5.3.2.1.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class, style, and grade required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Weight range required if other than specified (see 1.2.1.5).
(d) When type III rabbits are not required to be in accordance with 3.2.2.
(e) When in-process examination is not required by civil agencies (see 4.3.3.2).
(f) Levels of packaging and packing for types II, III, and IV all classes and all styles (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(g) Whether type I product, all classes and styles, is to be packaged in accordance with 5.1.2 or other than in accordance with 5.1.2 (see 5.1).
(h) When type I, all classes and styles, is to be packed other than in accordance with 5.2.
(i) When one style 2 cut-up rabbit is to be packaged in an individual carton (see 5.1.1.2 and 5.1.2).
(j) When level B packing in 5.2.1.1 or 5.2.1.2 is required (see 6.3 and 6.4).

6.2 Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15, NAVSUPINST 403.28/AFR 71-6/ MCO 4030.14D/ or DSAR 4145.7, as applicable.

6.3 Packing specified in 5.2.1.1 is intended for transfer at sea operations or specific Navy overseas operations.

6.4 Packing specified in 5.2.1.2 should be used when experience or knowledge of destination and mode of shipment would indicate that a lower grade of board can be used.

6.5 Destination inspection (for civil agencies only). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

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6.6 Award of contract for the product specified in this document will be limited to plants known to maintain the required sanitation conditions of 3.7 (also see 4.2)

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 45

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

HEW - FDA, NIH
USDA - AMS
VA - DMS

Project No. 8905-0792

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